

system. The difference is that the product may not necessarily be from a particular ‘brand’.

The online marketplace has changed the way people shop and eBay has been the pioneer of this concept globally as well as in India. Such a concept enables entrepreneurs to access wider markets and makes it possible for local products to be sold across the country as well as be exported across the globe. The marketplace concept is free of middlemen and unconstrained by geographical boundaries, thereby, enables frictionless trade between buyers and sellers. Moreover, for the e-commerce business, being a marketplace means they don’t need to hold inventory and they can focus on shipping and handling, thereby, enabling them to pick up products from the seller and deliver them to the buyer faster.

Within India, while eBay continues to enjoy popularity there are also a few players that have modified this concept to create a marketplace for all things Indian. One such being Shopo.in.



“Shopo is one of the first Indian marketplaces that was specifically created for Indian designer and handcrafted things. There are about 35.4 million handicraft artisans across India and platforms such as Shopo enable them to give their business exposure and their products a unique identity”, says Krithika Nelson, co-founder of Shopo.in

So, what’s needed to be successful? For the marketplace concept to be successful, the business must not only have excellent merchants selling unique products through their shops but it must also have a large community of subscribers to attract the relevant merchants. Moreover, with the world going social, marketplaces too need to go social as it enables customers to interact and engage with the website as well as the merchants that showcase their business on the site.

The dealmaker

Now here’s a model that is at most times a win-win for both customers and businesses, and has swept across the world. It is the dealmaker. With deal sites, customers get exclusive access to great deals from a wide variety of